

Round 2 — “Everyone’s a Suspect”

10:00 PM – 11:00 PM

Scene: Everyone’s inside. The party is over. The host opens, then turns the players loose to talk to each other. Move, pair off, trade alibis and secrets in conversation. **Yes-and rule:** if someone asks you something not on your card, play along; make it up consistent with your character.

- **Your alibi:** “Conference room. Tax shelter strategies with Gerald Finch and Lorraine Chu.” Smooth, prepared. Gerald nods before you finish speaking.
- **Share in conversation:**
 - Be calm. Steady hands, steady voice. **Check your watch once or twice — visibly.** Lorraine will count out loud later.
 - When Pam gets emotional, put your arm around her. “Leave her alone. She’s grieving.”
 - If asked about your phone call earlier in Spanish, wave it off: “My sister. She worries.”
- **Seek out:** Pam (control her — she’s a loose cannon), Gerald (lock him in), Marco (briefly, with a look only — never words).
- You are the calmest person in the room. That should worry people.

Your reaction when Lorraine calls out the watch count (late round)

Late in the round, Lorraine will speak across the room — addressed to you, but loud enough for everyone to hear: *“Mrs. Reyes. That’s four times in the last ten minutes you’ve checked your watch. Are we keeping you?”*

- Smile politely. Don’t break.
- **Deliver the line:** “Force of habit. PTA.”
- Then hold the room’s eye for one beat. Don’t elaborate.
- Lorraine will continue, evenly: *“Gerald checked his watch four times too. He was watching hers.”* Don’t react to that. Let Gerald sweat.